

GM Master Reference

Quick Rules • Loot Distribution • Cheat Sheet

QUICK RULES

Core Mechanic

- Player declares action and chooses ability or item to use
- Roll 1d20 + 2d6 (pick higher d6) + item bonus (if applicable)
- If you have 2 of the same ability: Roll 1d20 + both d6 added together
- Compare total to threshold - must roll ABOVE threshold to succeed

Combat Flow

1. Players attack: Roll d20 + ability dice vs. Defense Threshold
2. Enemies attack: GM rolls d20 vs. Attack Threshold
3. If enemy hits player: Player flips one ability card face-down (their choice)
4. If both abilities face-down: Player continues with items only
5. After battle: All abilities and armor flip face-up (restored)

Damage System

- Players: Take damage = flip 1 ability face-down (can't use that ability)
- If both abilities down: Still in fight, use items only
- Enemies: Track HP with checkboxes on enemy sheet
- Armor (players & enemies): Absorbs 1 hit, then destroyed
- Blade of Righteous Judgment: Deals 2 damage to un-armored enemies

Healing

- Healing items/abilities: Flip one ability face-up (player's choice which)
- Greater Healing Potion: Flip BOTH abilities face-up
- Can heal yourself or allies
- After battle ends: Everything restores automatically

Resistances

- If enemy is resistant to an ability type, attack automatically fails
- No damage dealt, but ability is NOT flipped (no penalty)
- Player learns that approach won't work - try something else

LOOT DISTRIBUTION

Starting Loadouts

- Blade-Bearer: Receives ONLY the Blade of Righteous Judgment + Strange Bun
- All Others: Draw 3 ability cards (choose 2, discard 1) + 1 weapon + 1 item
- Players can trade weapons & items during setup (not abilities)

During Adventure

- Small treasure: Draw 2 cards from Items deck, players share
- Medium treasure: Draw 3-4 cards, players pick in turn
- Major treasure: Draw 5+ cards, everyone gets something
- Enemy loot drops: Check enemy sheet for specific roll requirements

Legendary Items

- Given at specific story moments (GM decides when)
- Boss victory: Each player draws 1 Legendary
- Major moral choice rewards: Sometimes 1 Legendary to party
- These are EARNED through good choices, not random

Story Items

- Blade of Righteous Judgment: Given at start to chosen player
- Strange Bun: Given to Blade-Bearer at start with the Blade

DIFFICULTY THRESHOLDS

Roll Above These Numbers

- Very Easy: 6-8 (basic tasks, favorable conditions)
- Easy: 9-11 (simple challenges, some skill needed)
- Moderate: 12-14 (standard difficulty, requires focus)
- Hard: 15-17 (challenging, needs good roll or right ability)
- Very Hard: 18-20 (expert level, tough even with advantages)
- Extreme: 21-24 (nearly impossible, boss-level challenges)
- Impossible: 25+ (reserved for special circumstances)

Adjusting Difficulty On The Fly

- If party struggling: Lower thresholds by 2-3
- If party dominating: Raise thresholds by 2-3
- Priority: Keep game fun and moving
- Kids don't need to know the numbers changed

ABILITY USE EXAMPLES

MIGHT - Strength & Protection

- ✓ Attack with sword/hammer, break down door, lift heavy object
- ✓ Block attack with shield, grapple enemy, smash through wall
- ✗ Pick a lock, sneak quietly, solve a riddle

AGILITY - Speed & Finesse

- ✓ Dodge attack, shoot bow, climb wall, sneak past guards
- ✓ Balance on narrow ledge, catch falling object, quick escape
- ✗ Break down door, understand ancient text, heal wounds

INSIGHT - Spiritual Sensing

- ✓ Sense hidden evil, see through illusions, detect lies
- ✓ Diagnose curse/sickness, feel Deep Magic, anticipate danger
- ✗ Shoot bow, climb wall, solve mechanical puzzle

WIT - Clever Thinking

- ✓ Solve puzzle, spot enemy weakness, devise tactics, negotiate
- ✓ Notice hidden door, decipher map, disable trap, tell convincing lie
- ✗ Overpower with strength, commune with nature, heal emotionally

HEART - Compassion & Healing

- ✓ Heal wounds (after Insight diagnoses), inspire allies, calm angry person
- ✓ Show mercy, persuade through kindness, sense emotional states
- ✗ Attack enemy, pick lock, solve logic puzzle

CREATION - The Natural World

- ✓ Command animals, grow plants, purify corruption, track through wild
- ✓ Find safe path, identify herbs, call nature to help
- ✗ Pick lock, solve math puzzle, fight without nature's help

COMMON RULINGS

Can I use [ability] for [action]?

- If it makes sense narratively: YES
- If player has creative justification: Usually YES
- Encourage creative thinking - reward it with lower thresholds
- When in doubt, let them try (but maybe raise threshold)

Can I use an item AND an ability?

- YES - items give bonus to ability rolls
- Example: Use Might to attack + Sword gives +d6
- Example: Use Agility to climb + Rope gives +d6
- Items enhance what abilities already do

What if I don't have the 'right' ability?

- You can still try! Just roll d20 + item (no ability bonus)
- Or use different ability creatively (with GM approval)
- Teamwork: Someone else with right ability can help

Can we work together on one action?

- YES - one player leads, others assist
- Leader rolls with their ability
- Each assistant gives +1 to the roll (max +3)
- Must make narrative sense how they're helping

What about falling/environmental damage?

- Minor: No damage, just narrative consequence
- Moderate: Flip 1 ability face-down
- Severe: Flip 2 abilities or use major healing item
- Use judgment - keep it moving

GM TIPS

Keep It Moving

- Don't get bogged down in rules debates
- Make a ruling and move on (can adjust later if needed)
- 'Yes, and...' is better than 'No' most of the time
- If kids are having fun, you're doing it right

Encourage Creativity

- Reward creative solutions with lower thresholds
- Let players try unusual ability applications
- 'That's clever!' goes a long way
- Sometimes the best solution isn't combat

Support the Blade-Bearer

- They have no items/healing - party must share
- Remind party to protect them
- Give them spotlight moments (Blade warnings, final blow)
- Their sacrifice should feel meaningful

Balance Combat Difficulty

- Watch for frustration or boredom
- Adjust enemy HP on the fly if needed
- Enemies can flee if losing badly
- Victory should feel earned but achievable

Celebrate Good Choices

- Kindness to NPCs pays off later
- Mercy moments matter
- Working together is stronger than solo heroics
- Acknowledge when players embody Fruits of the Spirit